THE RIDER · No.12

BUSINESS · THE WORKING DJ'S TOOLKIT · GLOBAL

THE DJ PROPOSAL.

ONE DOCUMENT. SENT IN REPLY 1.

CLOSES THE WHOLE LOOP.

Clients book the DJ who makes it easy. This is the one-page document you reply with that collapses seven back-and-forth emails into a single yes. Works for any DJ in any region — fill in once, adapt to your currency and tax context, save as your template.

WHAT'S IN THIS DOCUMENT

01	THE ONE-PAGE PROPOSAL	The fillable template — the whole document on one page
02	FIELD-BY-FIELD GUIDE	What goes in each section, and why it matters
03	THE REPLY EMAIL	The 4-line email that goes with the proposal attachment
04	REGIONAL TAX & PAYMENT NOTES	What changes by country — India, UK, US, EU, Middle East
05	VARIATION NOTES BY EVENT TYPE	Wedding, corporate, club, private — what shifts by context

THE FRAME

A proposal isn't a sales pitch. It's the client's relief that they don't have to think.

Send it to every enquiry. Every time. In reply 1.

Compiled by Vic Naik · The Vic Fix · 19 years, 18+ countries, every kind of client.

01 · THE ONE-PAGE PROPOSAL

THE TEMPLATE.

Copy into a Word/Pages doc, fill in your details, save as PDF, send as attachment.

PERFORMANCE PROPOSAL

Prepared for: [Client Name] · Prepared by: [Your Name] · Date: [DD MMM YYYY]

EVENT *[Type — wedding, corporate offsite, club night, private party, festival slot]*

DATE & TIME *[Date] · [Start–End time, including setup]*

VENUE *[Venue name + city + country if touring]*

FEE

- Performance fee: [Currency] _____
- Travel & accommodation (if applicable): [Currency] _____ or billed at actuals
- Tax applicability: [Inclusive / Exclusive / Not applicable — see Regional Notes, p.5]
- Total payable: [Currency] _____

DELIVERABLES *[Set length(s), number of sets, breaks, format — DJ-only / DJ+MC / DJ+live]*

TECH REQUIREMENTS *[What I bring: USBs/laptop. What venue provides: 2x CDJs, mixer, monitors, mic. Soundcheck window required.]*

LOGISTICS *[Arrival, soundcheck, meal window, transport, dressing room, visa support if touring]*

PAYMENT TERMS *[Advance: __% on confirmation. Balance: __% on event day / within __ days] [Bank transfer / Wise / PayPal / local methods — see Regional Notes]*

AVAILABILITY *[Confirmed available for the above date — hold for 5 days from proposal date]*

CANCELLATION *[Cancellation within __ days: __% of fee retained. Rescheduling subject to availability.]*

CONTACT [Your Name] · [Phone] · [Email] · [Website / IG handle]

Thank you for considering. Confirm by reply or signed copy of this proposal.

02 · FIELD-BY-FIELD GUIDE

WHY EACH FIELD MATTERS.

Each section removes one friction point from the client's decision ladder.

EVENT · DATE · VENUE
First three lines. Confirms you read their enquiry. Clients notice when their event name is quoted back correctly. Clients abandon when they have to re-explain.

FEE
The single most important field. Break it into performance, travel, taxes, total. Never a range. Never 'depends on scope.' A named fee is the signal that you've worked with professionals before.

DELIVERABLES
What they're actually buying. Set lengths, number of sets, breaks, format. This stops the day-of surprise of 'wait, we thought you'd play 6 hours.'

TECH REQUIREMENTS
Clear 'I bring X / venue provides Y' split. Removes the back-and-forth about CDJs, monitors, mic setup. Shows you've thought about the stage, not just the music.

LOGISTICS
Arrival, soundcheck, meal, transport. These are the day-of questions every client eventually asks. For international bookings, add visa support, work-permit needs, flight preference.

PAYMENT TERMS
Advance % on confirmation + balance %. Named payment method. For international bookings specify currency and preferred transfer method (Wise, PayPal, SEPA, local bank). See Regional Notes.

AVAILABILITY & CANCELLATION
Hold the date for 5 days. State the cancellation terms clearly. These protect you AND tell the client you've been burnt before and know what you're doing.

03 · THE REPLY EMAIL

FOUR LINES. ATTACHMENT.

DONE.

The email that goes with the proposal. The entire exchange, if you get it right.

To: [Client]
Subject: Proposal — [Event name], [Date]

Hi [Name],

Thank you for reaching out. Pleased to confirm I'm available for your event on [date].
Full proposal attached — fee, deliverables, tech, logistics, and terms all included.
Happy to answer any questions. If it looks good, confirm by reply and I'll send the advance invoice.

Best,
[Your Name]

WHY THIS EMAIL WORKS

01 · THE FIRST LINE CONFIRMS AVAILABILITY.
The client's first fear is 'is this DJ even free?' You answer it in sentence one. Everything else gets read with relief.

02 · THE PROPOSAL IS ATTACHED, NOT PROMISED.
Don't say 'I'll send a proposal shortly.' That's a second email. Send it with this one. One exchange, not three.

03 · THE CLOSE NAMES THE NEXT STEP.
'Confirm by reply and I'll send the advance invoice.' The client knows exactly what happens next. No ambiguity.

04 · FOUR LINES. NO FLUFF.
Clients are busy. They don't want a paragraph about your 19-year career. They want to know if they can book you. Answer that question.

04 · REGIONAL TAX & PAYMENT NOTES

WHAT TO ADJUST BY REGION.

The template stays the same. Fee, tax and payment language shift by country. Always verify locally.

INDIA · INR
- Tax: GST at 18% if your turnover crosses the threshold — state 'inclusive' or 'exclusive' clearly
- TDS: Clients may deduct 10% (section 194J) or 2% (194C) at source — flag this upfront
- Payment: Bank transfer / UPI / cheque. Always issue a GST invoice if registered

UK · £ GBP
- Tax: VAT at 20% if registered (threshold applies) — state 'inclusive' or 'exclusive'
- Self-employed: Clients expect a clean invoice with your UTR / sole-trader name
- Payment: Bank transfer (Faster Payments), Wise, or PayPal. BACS for larger clients

US · $ USD
- Tax: No federal VAT — but state sales tax may apply in some states. 1099-NEC form expected
- Clients may require W-9 upfront for payments over $600/year
- Payment: ACH, Wise, PayPal, Zelle, Venmo for private clients. Direct deposit for corporate

EU (Schengen) · € EUR
- Tax: VAT varies by country (19–25%). Reverse-charge applies for B2B cross-border within EU
- Freelance/self-employed status (freiberuflich / autoentrepreneur) determines invoice format
- Payment: SEPA transfer (standard), Wise, PayPal. IBAN always provided

MIDDLE EAST (UAE, Saudi) · AED / SAR
- Tax: VAT at 5% (UAE, Saudi) — state 'inclusive' or 'exclusive'
- Payment: Often advance 100% required for international acts. Local bank or Wise. USD alt commonly accepted
- Visa: Entry permit / work visa usually sponsored by the venue or promoter — confirm in proposal

SOUTHEAST ASIA (Singapore, Thailand, Indonesia)
- Tax: GST (Singapore 9%) / VAT (Thailand 7%, Indonesia 11%) — region-dependent
- Payment: Bank transfer, Wise widely accepted. SGD or USD standard for international acts
- Work permit: Required for performances in most markets — flag timeline in logistics

ONE UNIVERSAL RULE
If you're billing in a currency you don't bank in, specify the exchange rate reference and who absorbs the FX cost.

05 · VARIATION NOTES BY EVENT TYPE

ONE TEMPLATE. FOUR CONTEXTS.

What to adjust by client type. Structure stays. Emphasis shifts.

WEDDING / PRIVATE CELEBRATION

- Add: Timeline coordination with planner, specific song requests window
- Add: Ceremony sound planning, backup DJ if ceremony is far from reception
- Fee: Usually highest segment — don't underprice. Travel + accommodation always extra.

CORPORATE (OFFSITE / BRAND EVENT / CONFERENCE)

- Add: Dress code, music curation discussion (brand-safe filter)
- Add: Formal invoice is mandatory. PO process may be required.
- Fee: Premium segment globally. Corporate pays well because the booker's job depends on it going right.

CLUB (RESIDENCY / GUEST SLOT / FESTIVAL)

- Trim: Logistics usually standard — venue handles tech, soundcheck, bar access
- Add: Promo requirements (artwork, bio, mix delivery) + door split if applicable
- Fee: Lower per-event but repeat frequency compensates. Negotiate on calendar access.

PRIVATE (HOUSE PARTY / INTIMATE EVENT / YACHT)

- Add: Max guest count, neighbour / sound restrictions, insurance clause
- Add: End-time flexibility clause — these events run over, name the overage rate
- Fee: Negotiable but hold a floor. Rich clients will test the number — don't flinch.

THE CLOSE

SEND THE DOCUMENT.

CLOSE THE LOOP.

WIN THE GIG.

Your fee protects your income.
Your contract protects your terms.
Your rider protects your performance.
Your proposal wins you the gig.

Four documents. One career.

THE REST OF THE SERIES

No.01 INSURE · Health insurance for working DJs
No.02 RATE · Pricing your work
No.03 TDS · Tax setup for Indian DJs
No.04 CONTRACT · The performance contract
No.05 EARS · Hearing protection
No.06 BRAIN · The neuroscience of DJing
No.07 MOMENTS · Music as memory
No.08 MACHINE · AI-proofing your craft
No.09 2030 · The global DJ economy
No.10 BODY · DJing longevity
No.11 ONE · The first three tracks
No.12 PROPOSAL · The DJ who makes it easy (this one)

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The Vic Fix · 19 years, 18+ countries
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